

Section 3. Import Control System (ICS2)

3.1 Introduction

All ships (with the exception of Norway) and aircraft (with the exception of Norway and Switzerland) carrying goods into the customs territory of the Union are required to provide specific details in advance of their arrival. This is done by submitting an Entry Summary Declaration (ENS) to customs at the first port or airport of entry.

Further information on ICS2 can be found on the [ICS2 Section](#) of the Revenue website.

3.2 Legal Provisions

EU legislation requires that an ENS must be lodged at the first point of entry into the customs territory of the Union before the:

- Arrival of goods in the customs territory of the Union, or
- The loading of containerised cargo in deep-sea traffic commences.

The ENS must be lodged electronically and must contain the data as set out in Annex B of the UCC DA/IA. In particular, it should be noted that the ENS is in addition to the electronic customs declaration (which is made through AIS) which continues to be required in order to enter the goods into a Customs procedure (Article 127 UCC).

3.3 The Import Control System (ICS2)

ICS2 is an EU wide electronic system for the lodging, handling and processing of an ENS, including the issuing of a Master Reference Number (MRN) for each ENS, the exchange of safety and security risk analysis results between Member States and the handling of diversions.

This system will introduce new business procedures in accordance with the UCC and it will support the following processes:

- Lodgement of the Entry Summary Declaration (ENS) (advance cargo information) to customs.
- Safety and security risk analysis by customs.
- Arrivals of means of transport.
- Control by customs of goods, where required.